

(v) What did Birbal say about the thief's stick ?

Ans. _____

(vi) Why did the thief cut his stick ?

Ans. _____

Session - 7

7 Mental Talk:

- You cannot hide a wrong doing that leads to another.
- It is the wise man who watches the fool.

Tail-piece

You enjoyed how cleverly Birbal caught the thief.

Read another story to learn an interesting way to find the guilty.

FINDING THE THIEF

One night an old man stopped at a small hotel in a village. There he ate his dinner, went upstairs to his room, and went to sleep. Soon afterwards the manager of the hotel came and woke him up and said, "Sir, please come downstairs, I need your help".

The old man got up and went down. "What has happened ?" he asked.

The manager said, "These five men came in last night. Now one of them says that his money is missing, and no one has left the room since then. We all have faith in you. Please tell us, if you can, who took the money".

"Go, get me a cock", said the old man. The manager went out, and brought him a cock. The men were wondering what he was going to do with the cock.

"Now" he said, "I'll get a pot". And he went to the kitchen and took a big pot which was kept over the fire.

"Now I'll turn the pot upside down over the cock," said the old man. He put the cock on the table and turned the pot upside down over it. After that he locked the door, and put the keys in his pocket.

"Put out the lights," he said, "and cover the fire". So they did that, making the room quite dark.



Then the old man said, "Now all of you line up and pass the pot one by one. Rub the pot with your hands as you pass. When the thief rubs the pot, the cock will crow three times".

All the men went by the pot and rubbed it. No sound was heard. The cock hadn't crowed at all.

"Anybody else who hasn't rubbed the pot?", asked the old man. Nobody spoke. "Light the lamps," he said.

The men lit the lamps and the candles again and got the fire going bright once more. The room was now well lit, as before.



Then the old man said, "Now, men, line up again and hold your hands up towards me". They did so and he looked carefully at all their hands. And there was only one man whose hands were not black from the soot on the bottom of the pot. So he pointed to the man with clean hands and said, "There's your thief! Catch him and make him give back the money that he has taken".

Word Note

diamond	: a very hard, bright, clear precious stone used in jewellery, ହୀରା
favourite	: (spoken as fevorit) : a person or thing that you like more than all others, ବେଶୀ ପ୍ରିୟ, ଭଲ ଲାଗୁଥିବା (ବ୍ୟକ୍ତି, ବସ୍ତୁ ଇତ୍ୟାଦି)
gem	: any sort of valuable stone used as jewellery, ରତ୍ନପଥର
jewellery	: rings, necklaces etc. that people wear as ornaments, ଅଳଙ୍କାର
pearl	: a small, hard, round white object that grows inside the shell of an oyster and used to make jewellery, ମୁତ୍ତା

Tail-piece

- crow(v) : to make a loud noise by a cock, କୁକୁଡ଼ା ରାବିବା
- downstairs : (opposite: upstairs), on or to the ground floor, ତଳ ମହଲା
- missing : lost, ହଜି ଯାଇଥିବା
- rub : to move your hand, a cloth etc. backwards and forwards over a surface, ଘଷିବା, ମାଜିବା
- turn upside down: move the top part to the bottom, ତଳ ମୁହଁ କରି ଓଲଟେଇବା
- soot : black powder that is produced when wood, coal etc. is burnt, ନିଆଁରୁ ବାହାରିଥିବା କଳା